Module 4: Invoice & Payment Management — User Help Guide

End-User Operations Manual for Freight Billing Desks, Accounts Receivable Teams & Finance Controllers

1. Module Overview & Operational Purpose

The **Invoice & Payment Management** module handles end-to-end financial billing, surcharge itemization, tax calculation, and payment collection for all shipping and logistics movements. It eliminates manual spreadsheet calculation errors by automatically computing taxable subtotals, GST/VAT amounts, grand totals, and remaining balances as charges or customer remittances are entered.

- **Who Uses This Module**: Freight Billing Executives, Accounts Receivable (AR) Specialists, Trade Finance Desks, and Branch Finance Managers.
- **How to Open**: Click **5. Invoice & Payments** in the left sidebar navigation, or click **Freight Billing** on the Dashboard.
- **Multi-Currency & Automated Statuses**: Supports billing in *USD, INR, EUR, GBP,* and *AED*, normalizes figures for executive dashboard reporting, and automatically updates payment statuses between *Issued, Partially Paid,* and *Paid* based on collected remittances.

2. Searching & Auditing Invoices (Left Panel)

The left-hand ledger displays all issued invoices, proforma bills, credit/debit notes, and their live settlement status:

- **Ledger Search Bar**: Search by Official Invoice Number (e.g., *INV/2026-27/1001*), Shipment Reference, Booking Reference, Customer Name, or SWIFT/UTR Payment Reference.
- **Payment Status & Currency Filters**: Filter the ledger by status (*Paid, Partially Paid, Issued, Overdue, Draft, Cancelled*) or by billing currency (*USD, INR, EUR, AED*) to focus on open receivables.
- **Sorting & Quick Actions**: Sort by Newest Invoice Date, Highest Total Amount, Highest Balance Due, or Status. Click the **Print** icon on any row to open a formatted, printable **Commercial Tax & Freight Invoice**.

3. Complete Field Reference Guide (Right Panel — Sections A to C)

The right-hand billing workbench is structured into three sections covering invoice headers, itemized freight surcharges, and payment settlement details.

Form Section	Key Fields Included	Operational Guidance & What to Enter
A. Invoice Identification & Linking	Invoice ID (Auto), Official Invoice No.*, Invoice Type*, Linked Shipment Ref*, Booking Ref, Customer ID*, Customer Name*, Billing Party, Customer Tax/GST ID, Invoice Date*, Due Date*, Billing Currency	Select the **Linked Shipment Ref** first — the system automatically populates the Booking Ref, Customer ID, Customer Name, Billing Party, Customer GST/VAT Tax ID, and default currency from the linked shipment and customer records. Choose the document type (*Tax Freight Invoice, Export Zero-Rated Invoice, Proforma Freight Invoice, Debit Note,* or *Credit Note*).
B. Freight, Terminal & Customs Surcharges	Exchange Rate, Basic Ocean/Air Freight*, Origin THC (OTHC), Destination THC (DTHC), BL & Doc Fee, Customs Clearance (CHA), Inland Haulage, Insurance & BAF, Demurrage/Other Charges, Commercial Discount, Taxable Subtotal (Auto), GST/VAT Rate (%), Tax Amount (Auto), Grand Total (Auto)	Enter the applicable charge amounts for each service line. As you type, the system automatically sums all freight and terminal charges, subtracts any **Commercial Discount** to display the **Net Taxable Subtotal**, applies your chosen **GST / VAT Tax Rate** (*0% Export LUT, 5% Ocean Freight, 12% Multimodal,* or *18% Standard Agency/THC*), and calculates the **Grand Total Amount**.
C. Payment Collection & Remittance Details	Amount Paid Received, Balance Due (Auto), Invoice Payment Status*, Payment Method, Payment / SWIFT / UTR Ref, Payment Receipt Date, Beneficiary Bank, Billing Notes & Remarks	When payment arrives, enter the **Amount Paid Received**. The system immediately calculates the remaining **Balance Due** and updates the status to *Partially Paid* or *Paid*. Record the payment method (*SWIFT Wire Transfer, NEFT/RTGS, Letter of Credit, ACH/SEPA, Cheque*), bank transaction reference, receipt date, and beneficiary bank details.

4. Step-by-Step Daily Workflows

1. **Issuing a New Freight Invoice for a Shipment**: Click **New** in the left panel. In Section A, pick the **Linked Shipment Ref** to auto-fill all customer and tax details. Set the Invoice Date and Payment Due Date. In Section B, enter the Basic Freight and applicable OTHC, DTHC, BL Fee, Customs, or Haulage charges, and select the Tax Rate. Review the auto-calculated Grand Total, then click **Save Invoice**.
2. **Recording a Customer Payment (Partial or Full Settlement)**: Click the invoice row in the left table to load it into the form. Scroll to Section C and type the received remittance into **Amount Paid Received**. Notice that **Balance Due** updates automatically and **Invoice Payment Status** switches to *Partially Paid* (if a balance remains) or *Paid* (if settled in full). Enter the SWIFT/UTR reference number and receipt date, then click **Update Invoice**.
3. **Previewing & Printing a Tax Invoice for the Customer**: While creating or editing an invoice, click **Preview Printable Invoice** at the bottom of the form (or click the printer icon in the left table). Click

Print / Save PDF in the preview header to generate a clean customer invoice.

5. Best Practices & Troubleshooting Tips

Common Scenario / Question	Recommended Action in Invoice & Payment Management
Billing an Export under Zero-Rated LUT / Bond	Select *Export Zero-Rated Invoice* as the Invoice Type in Section A and set **GST / VAT Tax Rate (%)** to *0% (Export LUT / Zero Rated)* in Section B.
Customer pays in two installments (e.g., 50% advance, 50% on delivery)	When the first 50% arrives, enter that amount in **Amount Paid Received** and save (status becomes *Partially Paid*). When the final 50% arrives, update **Amount Paid Received** to the full total amount and append the second transaction reference.
Exporting the invoice ledger for accounting audits	Open **6. Summary Reports** in the left sidebar and click **Export Invoices CSV** to download the complete billing and receivables table as a spreadsheet file.